



OPERATIONAL ASSESSMENT TOOL

The Operational Drag Checklist

15 workflow gaps most businesses don't know they're paying for. Check ✓ one or more — you're a candidate for a Workflow Audit.

ITEMS 01 – 08

☐ **01 Data entered manually into more than one system**
→ Every duplicate entry is a potential error and guaranteed time drain. If the same data lives in two places, someone maintains both.

☐ **02 Reports built by copying and pasting from multiple tools**
→ Manual reporting destroys accuracy and burns senior employee time. If it takes more than one click, it shouldn't be manual.

☐ **03 New client onboarding requires staff to repeat the same steps from memory**
→ Memory-dependent processes break the moment a key person is unavailable. This is also your highest compliance exposure point.

☐ **04 Approvals happen over email with no documented audit trail**
→ Email approvals are legally invisible. In a dispute or audit, they don't exist.

☐ **05 You've bought software that solves one problem but nobody uses consistently**
→ Shelfware is a symptom of failed implementation. You're paying for a tool that creates more workarounds than it solves.

☐ **06 Staff spends time on tasks they could explain to a machine in five minutes**
→ If it can be documented in a paragraph, it can be automated. Every hour here is an hour not spent on work requiring human judgment.

☐ **07 You don't know exactly how long your core processes take or what they cost**
→ You cannot optimize what you cannot measure. Unmeasured processes grow in cost invisibly until they become a crisis.

☐ **08 Customer follow-ups are tracked in someone's head or a personal spreadsheet**
→ Personal tracking systems disappear when people leave. This is pipeline leakage you can't see until revenue drops.



ITEMS 09 - 15



09

Invoice generation, billing, or reconciliation requires manual steps

→ Manual billing errors directly reduce revenue. Every manual step is a delay on money that's already been earned.



10

New employee onboarding has no repeatable, documented workflow

→ Inconsistent onboarding creates inconsistent employees. You're paying full salary for people at 60% capacity for months.



11

You find out about problems after they've already affected a client

→ Reactive operations mean your clients are your quality control system. Every client-reported issue is a preventable process failure.



12

File naming, storage, or retrieval has no enforced standard

→ Inconsistent file management costs employees 30+ minutes per day in search time. Multiply by headcount and add to annual labor cost.



13

Your team uses a different tool than officially sanctioned for the same task

→ Shadow IT is a security risk and an integration nightmare. It means your official stack isn't solving the actual problem.



14

There is no automated alert when something goes wrong in a critical workflow

→ Silent failures are the most expensive kind. If nobody knows a process broke until the output is wrong, you have no floor.



15

You've said 'we need to automate this' more than once without it happening

→ Repeated acknowledgment without action signals the problem exceeds your current team's capacity to solve internally.

READY TO FIX THIS?

Book a 30-Minute Workflow Audit Call

We'll map your highest-impact automation opportunities and tell you honestly whether we're the right fit to build them. No pitch. We diagnose before we prescribe.

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Book Audit Call